

POOYA KARAMBAKHSH

BSc, MSc, GradCert, MA, PhD
pooya@dianoetic.com.au | linkedin.com/in/pooya-karambakhsh

PROFILE

Political economist and researcher with a PhD from the University of Sydney and over 12 years of research experience spanning macroeconomic analysis, political economy, and international development. Published in peer-reviewed journals on global labour and profit dynamics. Combines rigorous quantitative and qualitative methods with critical political economy frameworks. Currently delivering macroeconomic research capacity-building for the National Reserve Bank of Tonga. Committed to research that serves the Global South and disadvantaged communities. Fluent in English and Persian.

KEY COMPETENCIES

Macroeconomic research & policy analysis	MEL framework design & implementation
Survey design & data systems	Econometrics (R, Python, Eviews)
Labour, migration & remittances	Data visualisation (Power BI, Python)

EDUCATION

PhD in Political Economy, The University of Sydney	2019 – 2024
Thesis: Analysing the world rate of profit: A new approach Scholarship: RTP (Tuition & Living)	
MA (Research) in Political Economy, The University of Sydney	2017 – 2019
Thesis: Transnational Australia Scholarship: RTP (Tuition)	
Graduate Certificate in Political Economy, The University of Sydney	2016 – 2017
MSc & BSc in Geotechnical Engineering, Sharif University of Technology	2001 – 2008
Ranked top 1% in National Entrance Exam	

PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

Macroeconomics and Research Mentor	Sep 2025 – Jun 2026
National Reserve Bank of Tonga, Tonga <i>Purpose: Capacity building in macroeconomic research and analysis (DFAT-funded)</i>	
Database Specialist	Jan – Jul 2025
The Australia Institute, Canberra, Australia <i>Purpose: Public policy and advocacy</i>	
Research Officer	Apr – Jul 2025
The University of Sydney, Sydney, Australia <i>Purpose: Public housing research support</i>	
Data and Systems Manager	Jun 2023 – Jun 2025
Dress for Success (NSW & ACT), Sydney, Australia <i>Purpose: Empowering women in securing and retaining employment</i>	
Business & Programs Data Analyst	Mar 2019 – Jun 2022
Save the Children Australia, Sydney, Australia <i>Purpose: Empowering underprivileged children and families</i>	

Data Analyst / Database Administrator Bobby Goldsmith Foundation, Sydney, Australia <i>Purpose: Supporting people living with HIV</i>	<i>Apr 2018 – Jul 2020</i>
Research Assistant ARC Centre for Geotechnical Science and Engineering, University of Newcastle, Newcastle, Australia <i>Purpose: Numerical simulation of geotechnical problems</i>	<i>Jun 2012 – Jan 2016</i>
Casual Academic University of Newcastle, Newcastle, Australia <i>Courses: Geomechanics 1 & 2</i>	<i>Sep 2013 – Jul 2015</i>
Geotechnical Engineer Tamavan Consulting Engineers, Tehran and Kazeroon, Iran <i>Project: Nargesi Earthfill Dam</i>	<i>Apr 2011 – Apr 2012</i>
Geotechnical Engineer Fars School Renewal General Office, Shiraz, Iran <i>Projects: Construction and renovation of 200+ schools</i>	<i>Dec 2009 – Feb 2011</i>
Geotechnical Engineer International Institute of Earthquake Engineering and Seismology, Tehran, Iran <i>Project: Construction of new advanced laboratories</i>	<i>Sep 2008 – Jul 2009</i>
Teaching Assistant Sharif University of Technology, Tehran, Iran <i>Courses: Undergraduate and advanced foundation engineering</i>	<i>Sep 2007 – Jun 2008</i>
Civil Engineer Sangtash, Shiraz, Iran <i>Projects: Metro Line and Station</i>	<i>Feb 2006 – Sep 2006</i>

POLICY & VOLUNTARY EXPERIENCE

Policy Officer (Volunteer) African Sub-Sahara International Development Agency (ASSIDA) Sydney, Australia	<i>Dec 2017 – Apr 2018</i>
Political Engagement Volunteer Micah Australia / RESULTS Australia Sydney, Australia	<i>2016 – 2017</i>
Researcher / Writer (Volunteer) All Together Now Sydney, Australia	<i>Jan 2017 – Jun 2017</i>

LANGUAGES

English: Fluent	Persian (Farsi): Native/Fluent
Arabic: Basic	Tongan: Basic

PUBLICATIONS

Peer-Reviewed Journal Articles

- Karambakhsh P. (2026) "Measuring the World Rate of Profit: A Marxian Approach", Review of Radical Political Economics. <https://doi.org/10.1177/04866134261420879>
- Karambakhsh P. (2020) "The Powers of Australian Retail Workers as a Section of the Global Working Class", Global Labour Journal, Vol. 11, Issue 2, pp. 118-133.
- Ahmadi, M.M., and Karambakhsh, P., et al. (2014) "Horizontal Stress Estimation Using CPT: a Database Approach", Sharif Journal of Science and Research, Vol. 30-2, Issue 1.2, pp. 95-106.

Working Paper

- Karambakhsh, P. (2026). Productive Labour and Profitability in Australia: A Marxian Assessment, 1963–2023. MPRA Paper No. 128475. Munich Personal RePEc Archive. <https://mpra.ub.uni-muenchen.de/128475/>

Conference Papers

- Karambakhsh, P. (2018) "The Social Structure of Accumulation: Theoretical-Historical Background and Contemporary Applications", ISEFE 2018, Bandirma, Turkey.
- Ahmadi, M.M., and Karambakhsh, P. (2010) "K0 determination of Sand Using CPT Calibration Chamber", CPT10.
- Ahmadi, M.M., and Karambakhsh, P. (2009) "A numerical study of the effects of calibration chamber boundary conditions on pressuremeter test results in sand", GeoHalifax 2009.

Theses

- Karambakhsh, P. (2024). "Analysing the World Rate of Profit: A New Approach." PhD thesis, University of Sydney.
- Karambakhsh, P. (2019). "Transnational Australia." MA (Research) thesis, University of Sydney.

Opinion Pieces & Blog

- Karambakhsh, P. (2017). "Is microfinance the best way to spend aid money?" On Line Opinion.
- Karambakhsh, P. (2017) "Australian foreign aid", On Line Opinion.

Blog

- Think Hammerly – Philosophising with a Hammer (ongoing). Blog on political economy and global development. thinkhammerly.wordpress.com